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Administrative and budgetary aspects of the financing of the United Nations peacekeeping operations

Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 for the United Nations Logistics Base

Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Appropriation for 2024/25	\$67,935,300
Allotment for 2024/25	\$67,935,300
Expenditure for 2024/25	\$66,750,100
Unencumbered balance for 2024/25	\$1,185,200
Appropriation for 2025/26	\$57,885,700
Projected expenditure for 2025/26 ^{a,b}	\$56,750,600
Projected underexpenditure for 2025/26 ^a	\$1,135,100
Proposal submitted by the Secretary-General for 2026/27	\$55,481,400
Adjustment recommended by the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	(\$34,700)
Recommendation of the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	\$55,446,700

^a Estimates as at 28 February 2026.

^b Includes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.



I. Introduction

1. During its consideration of the report of the Secretary-General on the financing of the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy (UNLB) ([A/80/605](#)), the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions met with representatives of the Secretary-General, who provided additional information and clarification, concluding with written responses dated 10 March 2026. The comments and recommendations of the Committee on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations are contained in its report ([A/80/604](#)), and those pertaining to the findings and recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 can be found in its related report ([A/80/633](#)).

II. Budget performance report for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025

2. The General Assembly, by its resolution [78/295](#), appropriated an amount of \$67,935,300 gross (\$61,366,000 net) for the maintenance of the Logistics Base for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, and decided that the amount of \$64,589,200 was to be prorated among the budgets of the active peacekeeping operations. Expenditure for the period totalled \$66,750,100 gross (\$59,557,600 net), for a budget implementation rate of 98.3 per cent, reflecting higher-than-budgeted expenditure for civilian personnel (\$1,088,500) and lower expenditure for operational costs (\$2,273,700). Allotment amounted to \$67,935,300 (or 100 per cent), though only \$66,231,500 (or 97.2 per cent) was issued by 30 June 2025 for spending/implementation. The balance of \$1,703,800 (2.8 per cent) was issued for financial year closure purposes and was not available for spending.

3. The Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that, during the reporting period, an amount of \$1,088,500 was redeployed from group III, operational costs, to group II, civilian personnel, to cover the increased requirements under group II attributable primarily to the retroactive salary increase for national staff in Brindisi by 3.8 per cent, that was not known at the time of preparing the budget proposal for the 2024/25 period.

4. The Advisory Committee was informed that unliquidated obligations amounted to \$2,634,700 (or 3.9 per cent of the total appropriation) as at 30 June 2025 for the 2024/25 period, representing a decrease of \$1,443,400 compared with the amount of \$4,078,100 as at 30 June 2024 for the 2023/24 period. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, unliquidated obligations amounted to \$2,496,000 for the 2025/26 period, comprising civilian personnel (\$28,400) and operational costs (\$2,467,600).

5. The unencumbered balance of \$1,185,200 in gross terms represents 1.7 per cent of the overall level of resources approved for the financial period. A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section III of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/605](#)). As indicated in section II.F of the report, other revenue and adjustments amount to \$3,723,100, comprising: (a) investment revenue (\$783,200); (b) other/miscellaneous revenue (\$2,732,400); and (c) the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$207,500). The Advisory Committee notes that, in paragraphs 104 and 132 of the report of the Secretary-General, it is proposed that credits comprising the unencumbered balances (\$1,185,200) and other revenue (\$3,723,100) be placed in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates (see para. 62 below).

6. The budgets of tenant units and the regional aviation safety office were transferred to their respective parent offices under the support account for peacekeeping operations, effective from the 2025/26 period, as approved by the General Assembly in its resolution 79/300. However, for consistency, the 2024/25 performance information is presented in the UNLB budget, where it was originally budgeted. As from the next period, performance reporting for these entities will be in the context of the support account (A/80/605, para. 22). **The Advisory Committee trusts that future reports of the support account will report on activities of support account units located in UNLB.**

III. Information on performance for the current period

7. Regarding current and projected expenditure for the period from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, expenditure amounted to \$36,786,100 (gross) and that, at the end of the current financial period, the estimated total expenditure would amount to \$56,750,600,¹ with a projected unencumbered balance of \$1,135,100, against the appropriation of \$57,885,700.

8. The Advisory Committee was also informed, upon enquiry, that, as at 2 March 2026, the cash available to the Logistics Base amounted to \$13,979,972, which was insufficient to cover the three-month operating reserve of \$14,471,425. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the cash position of the Logistics Base will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

9. Although a contingency plan was not applied to UNLB, the Advisory Committee was informed that, during the financial period 2025/26, UNLB operated under Organization-wide liquidity constraints. UNLB was prioritizing the commitment of allocated funds to cover recurrent contractual obligations and non-discretionary costs. It was also indicated that UNLB had been significantly impacted by exchange rate fluctuations, which had increased the costs of euro-denominated national staff salaries and operational costs, and placed additional pressure on limited resources. In the area of supply chain management, the liquidity situation and recruitment freeze had required the reprioritization and phased implementation of certain initiatives, including identified efficiency measures. In the digital technology area, budgetary limitations and liquidity pressures had significantly constrained the timely replacement of essential information and communications technology (ICT) equipment.

10. With regard to UNLB support to missions, the Advisory Committee was informed that contingency planning had resulted in greater reliance on centralized and remote digital technology, engineering, assets and property-management expertise, particularly where missions no longer retained sufficient in-house technical capacity to assess infrastructure risks, minimum operating standards or the operational implications of camp consolidation. The implementation of contingency planning had also resulted in increased reliance on UNLB support to identify and redeploy assets from existing inventories, including strategic deployment stocks, the United Nations reserve, the 3R (return, refurbishment and reuse) programme and mission surplus, to meet operational requirements.

11. The Advisory Committee trusts that an update and more detailed assessment on the impact of the liquidity challenges on the implementation of the mandate of the Base will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next performance report.

¹ Includes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

IV. Proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

1. Mandate and planned results

12. The Logistics Base has been in operation at Brindisi since late 1994, when a memorandum of understanding governing the use of the property and facilities at Brindisi, Italy, by the United Nations was signed by the Secretary-General and the Government of Italy. In successive addenda to the implementation agreement, three new warehouses were donated and additional premises, buildings and open areas were transferred to the Logistics Base by the Government. An agreement governing the use of premises in Valencia, Spain, by the United Nations was signed by the Secretary-General and the Government of Spain in 2009. An administrative agreement and an addendum to the administrative agreement providing for additional premises in Valencia were signed by the Government. The Logistics Base operates as a unified entity and its two sites at Brindisi and Valencia provide global geospatial and information and telecommunications technologies, service delivery and supply chain operational support and environmental technical assistance, as well as other enabling support services throughout the life of field missions, from start-up planning and preparation to liquidation. The mandate, planning assumptions and mission support initiatives for the 2026/27 period are summarized in section I of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/605).

Impact of the UN80 Initiative and culture of efficiency

13. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, within the context of the UN80 Initiative and the ongoing liquidity crisis, the focus would remain on non-location-dependent, system-based and monitoring-intensive functions delivered from UNLB, while missions retained operational ownership and minimum on-site capability for hands-on activities (see paras. 54–57 below on services provided to other entities). It was also indicated that UNLB was an integral contributor to four major UN80-enabled initiatives: (a) the United Nations Secretariat data centre consolidation initiative; (b) the digital hub initiative; (c) the new humanitarian compact; and (d) the unified services road map. Under the United Nations Secretariat data centre consolidation initiative, UNLB was supporting the progressive consolidation of data hosting, storage and processing into resilient, centrally managed enterprise data centres. Through the digital hub initiative, UNLB was positioned as a global service hub for centralized and remote digital technology services delivery. In support of the new humanitarian compact, UNLB would contribute to advancing more integrated and coordinated supply chain arrangements in humanitarian and complex operational contexts. Under the unified services road map, UNLB would support the gradual consolidation and harmonization of supply chain-related services across the Secretariat.

14. The Secretary-General indicated in the reports on UNLB (A/80/605) and the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda (RSCE) (A/80/611) that the activation of contingency plans in the 2025/26 period across peacekeeping missions in response to financial constraints has resulted in greater reliance on centralized support for the missions and increased workload for UNLB and RSCE. The Advisory Committee also notes the expanded role and clientele of both UNLB and RSCE approved by the General Assembly at its seventy-eighth session. **In view of the strategic importance of improved support services for a more efficient Organization, in the Secretariat and system-wide, the Advisory Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide a comprehensive assessment on the existing and foreseen roles of UNLB and RSCE in the context of the UN80 Initiative, taking into account their**

complementary roles and the operational benefits and efficiencies to be derived from centralized and consolidated support to peace operations and beyond.

15. Section II.C of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/605) provides information on efficiency gains, indicating that the estimated efficiency gains for 2026/27 amount to \$7,566,000, which include \$1,991,000 of internal efficiencies. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that proposed initiatives were subject to internal review to ensure that they did not undermine mandate implementation or introduce undue operational or financial risk. That approach helped ensure that reported efficiencies reflected genuine productivity improvements rather than deferred costs or risk transfer to future periods. The Committee was also informed that, looking ahead to 2026/27, if the liquidity constraints persisted, sustained liquidity pressures, staffing limitations, exchange rate volatility and deferred capital investments might progressively increase operational risk and limit the ability to modernize and proactively enhance support to client missions.

16. **The Advisory Committee notes that, as regards internal efficiencies presented by the Base, while some proposed reductions reflect structural efficiency gains resulting from process improvements, others are driven primarily by liquidity constraints and temporary expenditure compression. The Committee trusts that further information will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.** The Committee further discusses efficiency measures in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

2. Resource requirements

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
Civilian personnel	46 066.9	47 155.4	37 280.7	26 288.3	36 718.6	(562.1)	(1.5)
Operational costs	21 868.4	19 594.7	20 605.0	10 497.8	18 762.8	(1 842.2)	(8.9)
Gross requirements	67 935.3	66 750.1	57 885.7	36 786.1	55 481.4	(2 404.3)	(4.2)
Staff assessment income	6 569.3	7 192.5	5 818.7	4 112.8	5 787.1	(31.6)	(0.5)
Net requirements	61 366.0	59 557.6	52 067.0	32 673.3	49 694.3	(2 372.7)	(4.6)
Voluntary contributions in kind (budgeted)	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Total requirements	67 935.3	66 750.1	57 885.7	36 786.1	55 481.4	(2 404.3)	(4.2)

17. Detailed information on the proposed resource requirements by location (Brindisi and Valencia) is presented in section II of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/605). The total proposed requirements for 2026/27 in the amount of \$55,481,400 represent a decrease of \$2,404,300, or 4.2 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$57,885,700 for the 2025/26 period. For Brindisi, the proposed resources amount to \$43,183,100, reflecting a decrease of \$2,477,900, or 5.4 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$45,661,000 for 2025/26. For Valencia, the proposed resources amount to \$12,298,300, reflecting an increase of \$73,600, or 0.6 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$12,224,700 for 2025/26.

18. The estimated value of voluntary contributions for the 2026/27 period amount to \$8,331,400, representing financial contributions from the Government of Italy for

the purpose of improvements to the premises in use by UNLB at the Italian air force base at Brindisi, including staff and personnel (2 P-5 and 4 consultants) (A/80/605, para. 100). **The Advisory Committee acknowledges the voluntary contributions to the United Nations Logistics Base.**

Scalability model

19. Information on the scalability model is provided in paragraphs 81 to 83 of and annex II to the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/605). The staffing model categorizes UNLB operations into three functions: (a) Supply Chain Service; (b) digital technology service delivery, covering the Service for Geospatial, Information and Telecommunications Technologies; and (c) management – UNLB, comprising the Central Service and the Office of the Director. The budget proposal of UNLB includes changes in posts and positions driven by the staffing model, with the 2020/21 period as the baseline, as applied in the support account revised estimates for the 2025/26 period. The review also considered changes in scale of operations that may have occurred since the baseline year.

20. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the review showed that approximately 50 per cent of overall capacity requirements for UNLB and RSCE were driven by the scale of operations. Future staffing requirements for UNLB, both increases and decreases, would be subject to the scalability model. The model considered all posts and positions, including general temporary assistance, as well as contractors. While the model considered the nature of functions as explained above, it did not determine the grades of full-time equivalents. Those were addressed in the course of the usual budgetary process. For the 2026/27 period, the new staffing model (by function with reference ranges) applied to the budget proposal for UNLB took into account one new mission, the United Nations Support Office in Haiti (UNSOH).

Table 1

Application of the staffing model by function for the United Nations Logistics Base

<i>Function</i>	<i>Steps 1 and 2</i>	<i>Step 3</i>	<i>Step 4</i>
	<i>Gross reduction targets</i>	<i>Reduction since 2020/21^a</i>	<i>Net reduction required</i>
Management – UNLB (Office of the Director and Central Service)	(2)	–	(2)
Field supply chain	(18)	2	(16)
Digital technology service delivery	(24)	21	(3)
Total change	(44)	23	(21)

^a Reductions already made for UNLB between 2020/21 and 2025/26 relate to changes due to scale of operations under field supply chain services and digital technology service delivery, for a total of 23 positions, including 20 contractors.

21. **The Advisory Committee notes the information provided on the application of the scalability model to the budgetary process, including the proposed abolishments, and looks forward to the continued application and improvement of the model going forward on the basis of clearly defined baseline parameters that are verifiable and consistently applied over time. The Committee also notes that requirements expressed in full-time equivalents applied to the definition of ranges in field technology services include contractor workload and trusts that more information on the incorporation of non-staff-related full-time equivalents**

into different functions covered by the non-transactional scalability model, including in relation to the grade-/level-agnostic nature of the model, will be included in the next report (see also para. 56 below). The Committee also discusses scalability in its reports on the Regional Service Centre and the support account.

3. Civilian personnel

Category	Approved 2024/25	Approved 2025/26	Encumbered as at 28 February 2026	Proposed 2026/27	Variance
International staff	143	90	71	87	(3)
National Professional Officer	–	1	–	1	–
National staff ^a	302	288	250	268	(20)
Temporary positions ^b	2	2	2	2	–
United Nations Volunteers	2	2	1	2	–
Total	449	383	324	360	(23)

^a National General Service staff.

^b Funded under general temporary assistance.

22. The proposed resources for civilian personnel amount to \$36,718,600, representing a decrease of \$562,100, or 1.5 per cent, compared with the apportionment for 2025/26, primarily due to the abolishment of 21 posts based on the staffing model, two posts due to the closure of the Kuwait Joint Support Office, and the application of vacancy rates higher than those approved, offset in part by the impact of currency fluctuation between the euro and the United States dollar, and higher salaries for national staff than in the approved budget.

Recommendations on posts and positions

23. For 2026/27, the Secretary-General proposes a total of 360 civilian posts and positions (87 international staff, 1 National Professional Officer, 268 national General Service staff, 2 general temporary assistance positions and 2 United Nations Volunteers), comprising 20 in the Office of the Director, 90 in the Central Service, 129 in the Supply Chain Service and 121 in the Service for Geospatial, Information and Telecommunications Technologies. The proposed staffing complement reflects a decrease of 23 posts as a result of the proposed abolishment of 23 posts.

Abolishment

24. Based on the application of the scalability model, it is proposed that a net total of 21 posts be abolished as follows: 2 posts (1 G-4 Team Assistant and 1 FS-6 Finance and Budget Officer in Brindisi) under the management – UNLB function; 16 posts (2 P-3 Engineers, 2 G-7 Senior Logistics and Senior Contracts Management Assistants, 4 G-5 Logistics Assistants, 7 G-4 Assistants and 1 G-3 Maintenance Worker) under the field supply chain function; and 3 posts (1 G-6 Telecommunications Technical Assistant in Valencia and 2 G-5 Information Systems Assistants in Brindisi) under the digital technology service delivery function. Support services for the processing of payroll for UNLB national staff were provided by the Kuwait Joint Support Office, where two General Service staff members from the approved staffing of UNLB were embedded. In the context of the closure of the Kuwait Joint Support Office as of 1 July 2026, it is proposed that the two posts of Finance and Budget Assistant (G-4) be abolished (A/80/605, paras. 88 and 89).

25. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, the entities that had previously received support from the Kuwait Joint Support Office, UNLB, the United

Nations Disengagement Observer Force and the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon, as well as other special political missions, would only receive non-core services from RSCE in 2026/27. The Committee makes further comments in its report on the Regional Service Centre.

Conversion

26. One international United Nations Volunteer (Communications Officer) position is proposed for conversion to national United Nations Volunteer. The proposed change would ensure continuity of essential communications functions to support mission-critical outreach, and maintaining a dedicated specialist capacity at the national level will provide consistent, contextually informed messaging, strengthen local engagement and ensure rapid dissemination of accurate information ([A/80/605](#), para. 90).

Reclassification

27. Two reclassifications of Field Service posts (FS-6) to P-2 posts are proposed. One Geospatial Information Officer (FS-6) in the Infrastructure Operations Section in Brindisi is proposed for reclassification to Associate Geospatial Information Officer (P-2). Maintaining the post at its current level may limit the Organization's ability to attract candidates with the required academic background and digital skill set. One post of Information Systems Officer (FS-6) in the Client Solutions Delivery Section in Brindisi is proposed for reclassification to Associate Information Systems Officer (P-2) ([A/80/605](#), paras. 91–93).

Redeployment

28. One Senior Field Security Assistant post (G-7) is proposed for redeployment from the Office of the Director in Brindisi to the Base in Valencia to strengthen the Office of the Chief of the Service for Geospatial, Information and Telecommunications Technologies in fulfilling its responsibilities as head of premises and area security coordinator. Given the strategic importance of Valencia as a critical digital technology hub within the United Nations system, reliance on one staff member who is currently performing functions presents unacceptable operational risks ([A/80/605](#), paras. 94–96).

Continuation of general temporary assistance positions

29. The position of Occupational Health and Safety Officer (P-3), funded under general temporary assistance, was established on 1 July 2021 to strengthen the occupational safety and health capacity of United Nations entities. The continuation of this position is necessary to address work-related safety and health incidents, which ranged in number from 117 in 2020 to a peak of 202 in 2023 but has since decreased to a projected 134 at the end of 2025. The incumbent will support the significantly increased scope of services provided to approximately 50 locations. A position of Environmental Engineer (P-3), funded under general temporary assistance, was established on 1 July 2019 within the Environmental Technical Support Unit. The incumbent will continue to lead the water and wastewater pillar and will assist in the development and implementation of guidelines on water and wastewater and standard operational procedures ([A/80/605](#), paras. 97 and 98).

Vacant posts

30. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, there were 59 vacancies at UNLB. Information provided to the Committee indicates that, as at 28 February 2026, there were three posts vacant for two years or longer at UNLB, two of which are proposed for redeployment and reclassification, respectively. **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on vacant posts will**

be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget proposal. The Committee also trusts that all long-vacant posts will be critically reviewed in the next budget period. The Committee discusses vacant and long-vacant posts in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

31. The Advisory Committee was also informed that there were no positions encumbered by staff with approved requests for early separation who remained as at 28 February 2026. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed and updated information on all staff of UNLB who were approved for the early separation programme, as well as related costs, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Vacancy rates

(Percentage)

Category	Budgeted 2024/25	Actual 2024/25	Budgeted 2025/26	Actual as at 31 December 2025	Actual average January– December 2025	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Actual average, July 2025– February 2026	Proposed 2026/27
Civilian personnel								
International staff	9.8	14.7	11.0	17.8	15.4	21.1	17.8	15.4
National staff								
National Professional Officers	–	–	50.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	7.3
National General Service staff	5.9	6.0	4.8	10.4	7.3	13.2	9.4	7.3
United Nations Volunteers								
International	–	50.0	–	50.0	50.0	50.0	50.0	–
National	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	50.0
Temporary positions ^a								
International staff	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–

^a Funded under general temporary assistance.

32. The Advisory Committee notes that the proposed vacancy rates for international staff and national General Service staff differ from the actual average and actual rates as at 28 February 2026. **The Advisory Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide updated information on the latest actual and actual average vacancy rates to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, along with clear justification where the proposed rates differ from the actual rates, including as it relates to proposed abolishments, realistic projected recruitment and potential upcoming vacancies, to the extent possible.**

33. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for civilian personnel.**

4. Operational costs

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	Amount (6)=(5)-(3)	Percentage (7)=(6)÷(3)
Consultants and consulting services	173.4	60.3	165.9	44.7	80.2	(85.7)	(51.7)
Official travel	357.4	215.8	230.6	23.4	221.0	(9.6)	(4.2)
Facilities and infrastructure	6 515.7	5 916.5	6 100.5	3 177.7	5 757.1	(343.4)	(5.6)
Ground transportation	436.8	363.2	369.4	165.2	472.1	102.7	27.8
Air operations	9.0	6.9	—	—	—	—	—
Communications and information technology	13 228.1	12 382.9	12 678.5	6 891.4	11 337.1	(1 341.4)	(10.6)
Medical	73.4	54.8	71.1	24.9	51.8	(19.3)	(27.1)
Other supplies, services and equipment	1 074.6	594.3	989.0	170.5	843.5	(145.5)	(14.7)
Total	21 868.4	19 594.7	20 605.0	10 497.8	18 762.8	(1 842.2)	(8.9)

34. The proposed resources for operational costs for 2026/27 amount to \$18,762,800, which represents a net decrease of \$1,842,200, or 8.9 per cent, compared with the apportionment for 2025/26 in the amount of \$20,605,000, reflecting lower requirements mainly under communications and information technology, attributable primarily to the lower number of communications and information technology equipment planned for replacement, as part of the reduction in discretionary non-post expenditure, offset in part by increased requirements for maintenance (A/80/605, para. 127).

35. The Advisory Committee is not fully convinced that the justifications provided fully support some of the requirements listed below and provides the following observations and recommendations:

(a) Official travel: the proposed resources for 2026/27 amount to \$221,000, a decrease of \$9,600, or 4.2 per cent, as compared with the approved level of \$230,600 for 2025/26. The Advisory Committee notes that expenditure amounted to \$215,800 and \$361,200 in 2024/25 and 2023/24, respectively, against an appropriation of \$357,400 and \$397,100. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that \$186,692 was spent on non-training official travel in 2024/25, while \$201,000 is estimated for non-training official travel in 2026/27. **The Advisory Committee reiterates its view that greater use should be made of virtual meetings, online platforms and online training tools, and emphasizes that travel for conferences, workshops and meetings should be kept to a minimum in order to achieve efficiencies. The Committee therefore recommends a reduction of 5 per cent (\$11,100) to the proposed resources for official travel;**

(b) Ground transportation: the proposed resources for 2026/27 amount to \$472,100, an increase of \$102,700, or 27.8 per cent, as compared with the approved level of \$369,400 for 2025/26, attributable primarily to the planned replacement of the obsolete car monitoring system and the acquisition of a mobile column lift to support repair and maintenance of the vehicles and trucks for the United Nations reserve and 3R programme. The Committee notes that expenditure amounted to \$363,200 and \$346,100 in the 2024/25 and 2023/24 periods, respectively, against an appropriation of \$436,800 and \$495,100. **Taking into account the past expenditure pattern, the Advisory Committee recommends a reduction of 5 per cent (\$23,600) to the proposed resources for ground transportation.**

Petrol, oil and lubricants

36. For petrol, oil and lubricants, a total amount of \$99,800 is proposed for the 2026/27 period under: (a) facilities and infrastructure (\$44,200, a decrease of \$300 or 0.7 per cent); and (b) ground transportation (\$55,600, a decrease of \$10,800 or 16.3 per cent). **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on fuel costs will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.** The Committee further discusses fuel costs and management in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

37. **Subject to its recommendations in paragraph 35 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for operational costs.**

V. Support functions performed by the United Nations Logistics Base

Strategic and regional deployment stocks

38. The report of the Secretary-General indicates that the strategic deployment stocks have transitioned from a purely material-holding model to a more integrated, demand-driven “stocks and solutions” approach. This expanded model now supports a broader range of scenarios, including mission start-ups, mandate surges, health emergencies, natural or human-made disasters, and operational continuity requirements, while extending the client base to include special political missions; other Secretariat entities; United Nations agencies, funds and programmes; and regional organizations. In 2026/27, the Base will further advance implementation of the revised concept of operations, which will allow for accelerated stock rotation, reduced depreciation and improved resource utilization. The approach to deployment solutions will increasingly focus on delivering ready-to-use capabilities, with integrated enabling services such as installation, assembly, testing, commissioning and logistics support. The Base will continue to collaborate with RSCE to maximize the benefits of regional deployment stocks, ensuring that they continue to provide timely and effective support for the operational needs of all clients ([A/80/605](#), paras. 48–54).

39. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the issue of obsolescence in the strategic deployment stocks inventory was addressed through a structured approach that combined composition review, controlled replenishment and proactive rotation. Under the revised concept of operations, strategic deployment stocks composition was regularly reviewed against updated planning assumptions, standardized deployment scenarios and category management inputs. Replenishment was undertaken only to levels approved by the Strategic Deployment Stocks Board and was informed by lead times, life-cycle considerations and demand. In day-to-day management, obsolescence risk was mitigated through active inventory rotation via the integrated business planning process, through which strategic deployment stocks were consistently proposed as a priority sourcing option for missions’ start-up, surge and operational requirements. The expanded utilization of strategic deployment stocks to special political missions and other entities, in line with the revised concept of operations, further enhanced turnover and limited stock ageing. Inventory visibility was maintained through business analytical tools, enabling monitoring of shelf life and condition, while regular condition assessments and preventive maintenance of stored assets ensured continued operational readiness. In the context of fewer start-ups and multiple drawdowns, stock levels were set against updated planning assumptions and standardized deployment scenarios, rather than historical holding levels. Following the adoption of General Assembly resolution [79/300](#), UNLB had

initiated a structured review of the strategic deployment stocks composition, informed by updated planning assumptions, utilization data, life-cycle analysis and financial considerations. The review was being conducted under the oversight of the Strategic Deployment Stocks Board and applied a category management approach, whereby each commodity was assessed against defined deployment scenarios, demand patterns, lead times, technological evolution, storage and maintenance requirements, and availability through alternative sourcing modalities. The objective was to ensure that strategic deployment stocks remained demand-driven, financially proportionate and aligned with realistic start-up and surge requirements.

40. The Advisory Committee was also informed that strategic deployment stocks at UNLB in Brindisi remained the centrally managed strategic reserve, responsible for global planning assumptions, funding, accounting, replenishment and the overall governance of stock holdings. Regional deployment stocks at RSCE were an integral component of the overall strategic deployment stocks framework, positioned to support missions in the East Africa region with selected equipment and assets. While RSCE managed the physical storage and operational readiness of regional deployment stocks, deployment decisions remained within the centrally governed strategic deployment stocks framework.

41. The Advisory Committee recalls that it previously emphasized the need to ensure that the acquisition plans and inventory levels of strategic and regional deployment stocks followed a demand-driven approach based on actual operational needs and trusted that a comprehensive review of appropriate levels and the cost-effectiveness of the strategic deployment stocks would be undertaken and presented to the General Assembly during its eighty-second session ([A/79/724/Add.6](#), paras. 31 and 32). **The Advisory Committee notes the introduction of the “stocks and solutions” approach and trusts that more information on asset turnover rates and obsolescence, as well as the percentage intake of strategic deployment stock assets by missions when indicated by UNLB, will be provided in future UNLB and overview reports. The Committee looks forward to the results of the structured review of strategic deployment stocks, including the role of regional deployment stocks, being provided in the report for the eighty-second session.**

Internal sourcing

42. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that internal sourcing options were proposed through the integrated business planning process in order to support global inventory management, prioritizing the use of existing stocks, including strategic deployment stocks, the United Nations reserve, surplus assets across missions and the 3R programme, before initiating new procurement. The approach strengthened transparency, coordination and governance in central supply planning and the allocation of existing inventory across missions. The Committee was also informed, in the context of the report on supply chain activities in the United Nations Secretariat, that uptake rates were highest for refurbished assets under the 3R programme (100 per cent), mission surplus (nearly 100 per cent) and the United Nations reserve (98 per cent), as those options involved minimal costs beyond transportation. The uptake of strategic deployment stocks was lower (approximately 42 per cent), mainly reflecting persistent mission liquidity constraints. While the higher rate of uptake of internal sourcing solutions is expected to increase over time, it may be temporarily affected by the ongoing financial situation and reduced acquisition levels ([A/80/653](#), para. 22). **The Advisory Committee notes the Secretariat’s efforts to strengthen inventory management, including through the prioritization of existing stocks over new acquisitions, and further encourages the Secretariat to increase the level of uptake of internal sourcing solutions, whenever cost-effective, including through the establishment of a clear policy**

and guidelines for the missions. The Committee trusts that further information in that regard will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next report.

43. The Advisory Committee was further informed that UNLB considered that all items acquired through the proposed strategic deployment stocks, the United Nations reserve, the 3R programme and missions' surplus should be reflected as modified or cancelled procurement actions as, currently, UNLB was not structured to monitor the actual procurement activities of entities across the Secretariat and, therefore, was not able to confirm whether the acquisition of items had been cancelled (if sourced from existing inventories) or had proceeded through procurement. As reported by the Secretary-General in the report on budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, internal sourcing solutions with a cumulative value of \$16.7 million were accepted by United Nations entities and were considered as cancelled and/or modified procurement. With respect to comparative fulfilment time, internal sourcing options offered significantly shorter lead times than external procurement, as items were already available in stock and did not require production lead time, vendor processing or full solicitation cycles. The Secretariat did not currently apply formal quantitative targets or benchmarks regarding the substitution of procurement with internal sourcing. However, internal sourcing mechanisms were promoted as preferred options, where feasible, in support of cost-efficiency and sustainability objectives. **The Advisory Committee concurs that items sourced internally should be reflected as modified or cancelled procurement and recommends that the General Assembly request the Secretary-General to include information in that regard in efficiencies presented in the context of budget proposals.**

System-wide inventory management

44. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the warehouse optimization project had been implemented through a phased approach, using mainly existing internal expertise, current Umoja functionality and minimal additional resources. Phase 1, which had focused on the management and storage of accoutrements, had successfully demonstrated improved inventory visibility, traceability and transaction accuracy. In that context, UNLB had introduced organization-wide packaging and labelling standards in 2025/26, which were being tested for accoutrements from strategic deployment stocks. The initiative streamlined storage and movement of goods by reducing errors, damage and preparation time through standardized packing. The introduction of digitally readable labels for items and bin locations was expected to generate warehouse resource efficiencies in the range of 20 to 35 per cent in processing time. In parallel, smart QR code labelling had been implemented and was currently being used in active deployments, including UNSOH. The QR code labelling provided immediate and full visibility of a consignment's contents.

45. The Advisory Committee reiterates the importance of efficient system-wide inventory management to avoid overstocking, and recommends that the General Assembly request the Secretary-General to examine comparable digital supply chain initiatives within the United Nations system and provide information in the next report on the outcome of the analysis, identifying opportunities for synergies or adoption of proven approaches that the Secretariat considers feasible and cost-efficient (see also [A/80/653](#), para. 53).

Management of sea containers

46. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that containers formed part of the Organization's property portfolio and that, under the current governance framework, entities with delegated property management authority were responsible

for ensuring that containers were effectively managed, utilized and aligned with operational requirements. Operational requirements for containers were integrally linked to mission mandates, operational imperatives, geographical conditions and logistical challenges, which varied significantly across peacekeeping and special political missions. Headquarters did not centrally validate or prescribe operational container requirements by quantity or configuration. UNLB maintained and managed containers related to strategic deployment stocks and the United Nations reserve at the Base in Brindisi. The Committee discusses management of containers in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

3R (return, refurbishment and reuse) programme

47. The report of the Secretary-General indicates that, to optimize efficiency and generate cost savings, the Base is integrating the 3R approach into its strategic asset management framework through full alignment with the integrated business planning mechanism, ensuring that the 3R is considered as an equal and alternative sourcing option alongside the strategic deployment stocks and the United Nations reserve. This strategy aligns with the five-year asset replacement plans and focuses on high-value assets (acquisition value of \$150,000 or more), for which refurbishment has consistently delivered significant cost avoidance and operational benefits. The Base is spearheading efforts to classify assets at the global level and further expand its refurbishment capacity. To this end, the 3R programme is actively seeking to establish partnerships with certified vendors of original equipment at refurbishment centres located closer to mission areas, which has the potential to reduce total logistical and refurbishment costs as well as overall turnaround times ([A/80/605](#), paras. 60 and 61).

48. In addition, UNLB is expanding the 3R programme through a pilot refurbishment initiative at the United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS), involving two Caterpillar road graders to be refurbished in Kenya by a certified regional partner that manufactured the original equipment, with completion expected in 2025/26 ([A/80/605](#), para. 40; see table 2 below). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, following technical on-site assessments and independent procurement market research, a facility in Nairobi was selected. The facility, operated by Mantrac Kenya, provided comprehensive and high-standard refurbishment solutions and aligned with the broader 3R strategic goals, such as regional capacity-building and the realization of efficiency gains. The pilot project was specifically designed to test the refurbishment viability through regional service providers in the Global South and, if successfully concluded, would provide a scalable and sustainable model for potential future refurbishment activities within the region. In balancing refurbishment at UNLB and the use of regional refurbishment centres, the Secretariat intended to adopt a practical approach based on the complexity of the equipment. Standard equipment sourced from a single manufacturer, without significant modifications or integrated systems from multiple vendors, might be suitable for refurbishment at qualified regional facilities. More complex and specialized equipment that combined components from multiple manufacturers would continue to be refurbished at UNLB. The Committee was also informed that there was no historical baseline or pricing data that would allow for a comparison with an equivalent refurbishment undertaken in Brindisi, nor was it possible to provide information on the comparative cost of purchasing new equipment.

Table 2
Preliminary costs of refurbishing two road graders

<i>Item</i>	<i>Amount</i>
Caterpillar road grader, 140H	\$142 824.24
Caterpillar road grader, 140M	\$79 090.73
Freight	\$19 000.00
Total cost	\$240 914.96

49. The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the 3R pilot project at UNMISS for the regional refurbishment will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next report. The Committee considers that a comprehensive cost-benefit analysis comparing refurbishment at different locations should guide future plans for the 3R programme. In that regard, the Committee trusts that results of the comprehensive cost-benefit analysis and information on the types of items to be refurbished regionally, related comparative costs and further details on the possible expansion of refurbishment centres, will be provided in the next budget proposal (see [A/79/724/Add.6](#), para. 45).

Use of new technologies

50. In 2026/27, the United Nations smart camp initiative will remain a key pillar enabling missions to operate more responsibly through the ongoing development of the Unite field remote infrastructure monitoring system, its integration with contingent-owned equipment, and the effective use of infrastructure and environmental data. The Base will also advance the integration of the electronic fuel management system with field remote infrastructure monitoring, supporting real-time monitoring and data automation for over 8,600 generators in remote locations, to improve fuel efficiency, reduce manual reconciliation and strengthen resource management and operational accountability. The initiative will also explore extending these technologies to contingent-owned equipment, which comprises 51 per cent of United Nations camps ([A/80/605](#), para. 72).

51. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNLB was able to access mission-level field remote infrastructure monitoring dashboards upon request. While that access was not provisioned by default and was subject to formal service requests, in accordance with the UNLB service catalogue, it provided UNLB with the technical means to independently review dashboard outputs when required. The dashboards provided visibility on the status of alerts, including whether they had been acknowledged at the mission level and by which user. Additionally, start and end timestamps were captured, allowing confirmation that cases had been opened, worked on and closed. That established an auditable trail of actions taken in response to anomalies and significant variances. By consolidating high-volume, high-quality transactional and control data into a centralized data environment, field remote infrastructure monitoring effectively functioned as an enterprise data lake that could be leveraged for advanced analytics. That positioning was strategically significant for the Organization's digital transformation agenda. As field remote infrastructure monitoring continued to mature, its data assets could support the future deployment of artificial intelligence-driven capabilities, such as predictive risk modelling, intelligent anomaly detection, trend analysis and automated second line of defence oversight. In that context, UNLB could, through controlled and role-based access, monitor volumes of anomalies and significant variances being generated,

acknowledged, investigated and closed by first-line entities, thereby strengthening independent assurance without duplicating operational controls.

52. The Advisory Committee notes the importance of a strengthened second line of defence and underlines that UNLB access to field remote infrastructure monitoring data should not be subject to a formal service request. The Committee recommends that the General Assembly request the Secretary-General to establish a framework for UNLB use of field remote infrastructure monitoring for strengthened monitoring and independent assurance on the performance of operational controls at the first line of defence and to report thereon in the next report.

53. The Base will continue to support risk mitigation, situational awareness and operational readiness by leveraging advanced tools such as geo-intelligence analysis, real-time asset tracking and digital twin technologies. Solutions, including the United Nations Maps Mobile, tracking as a Service, 3D Camp Manager and extended reality applications, will continue to enable missions to navigate remote areas, simulate emergencies and train personnel safely and cost-effectively. The Base will also continue to support implementation of the Department of Peace Operations integrated base defence policy (2023) by managing sensitive technologies that improve surveillance, patrol efficiency and the overall security posture of field operations (A/80/605, para. 75). **The Advisory Committee sees merit in the use of new technologies to derive efficiencies, when appropriate, and trusts that more information will be provided in future reports.**

Services provided to other entities and cost recovery

54. The report of the Secretary-General indicates that the Service for Geospatial, Information and Telecommunications Technologies provided a host of technology, telecommunications and consultancy services on a cost-recovery basis. The Supply Chain Service delivered technical training and operational support, including property management, logistics, engineering, environmental assistance and equipment maintenance, to peacekeeping missions and other United Nations entities, such as the Development Coordination Office, the Department of Safety and Security and the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs. The revenue generated by the Service for Geospatial, Information and Telecommunications Technologies and the Supply Chain Service amounted to \$18.8 million and \$0.6 million, respectively (A/80/605, para. 27).

55. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that remote property management support provided by UNLB on a full cost-recovery basis covered structured technical and administrative services related to the management of property records and associated financial reporting. The activities included system recording and maintenance of asset and equipment data; remote receipt processing based on documentation provided by the client entity; annual remote verification coordination and reconciliation; financial reconciliation between asset records and accounting balances; preparation of asset movement reports for year-end financial closure; advisory support on compliance with property management rules; and preparation of documentation for transfers, write-offs and disposals, including support to property review bodies. The remote property management capacity at UNLB provided centralized, non-location-dependent property management services to the resident coordinator system and the Department of Safety and Security on a full cost-recovery basis. The clients owned the property managed. Support for the property management activities of the resident coordinator system was provided centrally by UNLB to ensure a single reporting structure, consistent data quality and clear accountability. The UNLB cost recovery framework was subject to annual

review by the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget. The Office approved the UNLB service rate card and the cost plans issued during the year, which detailed the estimated consumption of goods and services required to support cost recovery activities. In addition, the Board of Auditors had independently reviewed the UNLB cost recovery practices.

56. The Advisory Committee notes the information provided and reiterates that future budget and performance reports should include information on the services provided to various entities. The Committee also trusts that the Base will continue to provide information on the resources required to provide services under cost-recovery arrangements, including posts and positions and the recording of related income and expenditure, as well as more detailed information on the scalability of cost-recovery personnel capacities and how it compares to the new staffing model (see also [A/79/724/Add.6](#), para. 38).

57. With respect to training, the Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that UNLB primarily supported globally oriented and technically specialized training, including training on enterprise systems, ICT platforms and global supply chain management systems, engineering and technical workshops, and cross-mission functional training. Training was hosted in response to formal requests and programme requirements, and UNLB did not independently determine the allocation of training between service centres. **The Advisory Committee trusts that more information on the complementarity of training activities among the service centres will be provided in the next report.**

VI. Other matters

Budgets of the Regional Service Centre and the United Nations Logistic Base

58. Annex II to the report of the Secretary-General indicates that the recommendation of the consultant who conducted a review of peacekeeping support functions performed by UNLB and RSCE was to maintain single budgets for UNLB and RSCE and charge an appropriate allocation to both the peacekeeping and regular budgets for the UNLB budget, as is already done for the RSCE budget, to address current mismatches between work and funding sources and support a functional and service-based delivery model ([A/80/605](#), annex II, para. 21 (a)). While the Secretariat concurs with the consultant's recommendation on charging a portion to special political missions by maintaining a single budget for UNLB, the implementation of this recommendation will be deferred to future periods, taking into account the ongoing significant changes in the scale and scope of peacekeeping and special political missions and any lessons learned from the utilization of the model. **The Advisory Committee recommends that the General Assembly request the Secretary-General to undertake the necessary analytical work to charge an appropriate allocation of the UNLB budget to both peacekeeping and regular budgets in future budget proposals and to provide updated information in the next report.**

Equitable geographical representation and gender parity

59. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, UNLB comprised 324 staff at all levels. Among the 83 international staff, 40 nationalities were represented. Of the total 324 staff, 201 were men and 123 were women.

60. As at 28 February 2026, international staff were from the following regional groups: African States (8); Asia-Pacific States (13); Eastern European States (19);

Latin American and Caribbean States (6); and Western European and other States (30); as well as from the United States of America (7).

61. **The Advisory Committee trusts that the Logistics Base will further increase its efforts to promote equitable geographical representation and gender parity.** The Committee discusses equitable geographical representation and gender parity in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

VII. Conclusion

62. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of the Logistics Base for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/605](#)). **The Advisory Committee notes the unencumbered balance of \$1,185,200 for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, as well as other revenue amounting to \$3,723,100 from investment revenue (\$783,200), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$2,732,400) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$207,500) for the period ended 30 June 2025. The Committee also notes the proposal of the Secretary-General to place the credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates. The Committee considers that this is a policy matter to be decided by the General Assembly.** The Committee makes further comments in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations ([A/80/604](#)).

63. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of the Logistics Base for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/605](#)). **Taking into account its observations and recommendations above, the Advisory Committee recommends that the proposed resources be reduced by \$34,700, from \$55,481,400 to \$55,446,700. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly appropriate the amount of \$55,446,700 for the maintenance of the Logistics Base for the 12 -month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027.** A summary of the budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Committee with regard to the financing of the Logistics Base for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is presented in table 3 below.

Table 3

Budgetary impact and financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee for the United Nations Logistics Base for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

<i>Category</i>	<i>Paragraph number (present report)</i>	<i>Recommendation of the Advisory Committee</i>	<i>Financial implication (United States dollars)</i>
Operational costs			
Official travel	35 (a)	Reduction of 5 per cent (\$11,100) to the proposed resources for official travel.	(11 100)
Ground transportation	35 (b)	Reduction of 5 per cent (\$23,600) to the proposed resources for ground transportation.	(23 600)
Total			(34 700)